

# Adrian Mercer

Node.js Backend Developer

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## Summary

Backend Developer with 5 years of experience designing, building, and optimizing scalable server-side applications in the Node.js ecosystem. Strong background in REST API development, authentication systems, database design, microservices, and performance optimization. Experienced in PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Docker, and CI/CD delivery. Collaborative engineer with a proven record of working across product, frontend, and DevOps teams in agile environments to deliver reliable, maintainable software for international businesses.

## Skills

- Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL
- Frameworks: Node.js, NestJS, Express.js, Prisma, REST API, JWT
- Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis
- DevOps: Docker, Git, CI/CD, Linux
- Testing: Jest, Supertest, Postman

## Professional Experience

### Senior Backend Developer

Northgrid Labs — Toronto, ON, Canada

Mar 2023 – Present - Designed and maintained scalable RESTful services using Node.js, NestJS, and PostgreSQL for SaaS products serving 80K+ monthly active

users. - Reduced API response time by approximately 35% through query optimization, Redis caching, and database indexing strategies. - Led migration from monolithic modules to a service-oriented architecture, improving deployment reliability and reducing release rollback incidents. - Implemented secure JWT-based authentication and role-based access control across multiple internal and customer-facing services. - Collaborated with frontend, product, and DevOps teams to deliver features on biweekly sprints with high delivery predictability.

## Backend Developer

BrightStack Systems — Vancouver, BC, Canada

Jan 2021 – Feb 2023 - Built and maintained backend APIs with Express.js and NestJS for B2B workflow and analytics platforms. - Developed database schemas and Prisma ORM integrations with PostgreSQL and MongoDB, improving development velocity and maintainability. - Increased test coverage to over 85% using Jest and Supertest, significantly reducing regression issues in production. - Containerized services with Docker and supported CI/CD pipelines to streamline staging and production deployments. - Integrated third-party APIs for payment, email, and document processing workflows.

## Junior Backend Developer

Maplebyte Technologies — Ottawa, ON, Canada

Jun 2019 – Dec 2020 - Assisted in developing REST APIs and authentication modules using Node.js and Express.js. - Built reusable backend utilities and middleware that reduced duplicate implementation effort across projects. - Monitored logs, fixed production bugs, and supported incident resolution to maintain strong service stability. - Worked closely with senior engineers on schema design, API documentation, and code reviews. - Participated in agile ceremonies and contributed to continuous improvement of engineering practices.

# Projects

## API Authentication System

Built a production-grade authentication service using Node.js, NestJS, JWT, Redis, and PostgreSQL for secure user access management. - Implemented access and refresh token workflows with token rotation, revocation, and secure password hashing. - Added role-based authorization, audit logging, and session tracking to support secure enterprise use cases. - Used Redis for token blacklisting and fast session validation, improving response time for authentication checks. - Supported stable authentication flows for multiple client applications with consistent access control behavior.

## Resume Analyzer API

Developed an API that processes resumes, extracts structured candidate data, and scores profiles against job requirements. - Built REST endpoints with Node.js and Express.js for file upload, parsing, scoring, and candidate search workflows. - Designed a parsing pipeline that normalizes unstructured resume content into structured records stored in MongoDB and PostgreSQL. - Improved processing efficiency through modular extraction logic and reusable validation layers. - Enabled recruiter-facing use cases such as rapid screening, profile comparison, and shortlist generation.

## Microservices-based Task Manager

Created a modular task management backend using NestJS, PostgreSQL, Redis, and Docker for scalable team collaboration. - Separated the system into task, project, and user modules to support maintainability and independent evolution. - Applied event-driven communication and queueing concepts to improve asynchronous processing and service resilience. - Used Redis for caching and job coordination, enhancing performance under concurrent workloads. - Improved reliability and extensibility for teams managing shared task workflows and operational automation.

# Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Ottawa — Ottawa, ON, Canada

2019

# Certifications

- NestJS Fundamentals Certificate — Udemy, 2023
- Docker & Kubernetes: The Practical Guide — Udemy, 2022
- PostgreSQL for Developers — Coursera, 2021